

Candidate Number

Candidate Name _____

INTERNATIONAL ENGLISH LANGUAGE TESTING SYSTEM

Academic Reading

Additional materials:

Answer sheet for Listening and Reading

Time 1 hour

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Do not open this question paper until you are told to do so.

Write your name and candidate number in the spaces at the top of this page. Read the instructions for each part of the paper carefully.

Answer all the questions.

Write your answers on the answer sheet. Use a pencil.

You must complete the answer sheet within the time limit.

At the end of the test, hand in both this question paper and your answer sheet.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

There are **40** questions on this question paper.

Each question carries one mark.

READING PASSAGE 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

Conquering the South Pole

An explorer in the 20th century

Roald Amundsen, the Norwegian explorer celebrated for navigating the Arctic's Northwest Passage from Atlantic to Pacific in 1906, turned his sights southward in 1911 to claim the ultimate exploratory prize: the South Pole. His September 12 diary captured the harsh realities: "Limited visibility. Harsh southern wind. -52°C. Dogs evidently suffering from the cold... warmer weather prospects uncertain."

This expedition, though meticulously planned, pivoted on chance. In 1909, while preparing for the North Pole, Amundsen learned of American Robert Peary's disputed claim there, prompting an immediate shift south to secure fame and future funding.

Yet rivalry intensified the challenge. Captain Robert Falcon Scott's well-publicized British team was also advancing. Anxious to outpace Scott, Amundsen started prematurely in September, before spring's milder conditions, resulting in frostbitten feet that demanded a month's healing. Objectively assessing the risks four days in, he retreated to save lives, a prudent move underscoring the unpredictability of polar exploration. Amundsen's ambition was tempered by mastery over impulses, knowing when to withdraw, unlike the British emphasis on character prevailing through struggle over skill.

Restarting on October 20, his party traversed uncharted terrain: navigating crevasses, skirting Queen Maud Mountains' abysses and ice, and enduring the Polar Plateau's volatile weather. On schedule, they reached the geographic South Pole on December 14, 1911.

Before departing, Amundsen left a letter for Norway's King Haakon VII, including a note for Scott ensuring proof of victory if disaster struck, while subtly asserting triumph. Scott honorably preserved it. Returning January 26, 1912, they discarded surplus food that later aided Scott's malnourished group, weakened by vitamin-deficient rations and underestimated caloric needs.

Amundsen's efficiency shone in contrast: four dog-pulled sleds with expert skiers trailing, versus Scott's ponies, unreliable motor sleds, and men walking or dragging loads due to poor skiing skills. Amundsen's flagged depots, stocked triple Scott's supplies,

ensured survival, reflecting Norway's intolerance for failure: depart and return whole, prioritizing expertise over mere grit.

Amundsen's success rested on precision and adaptation rather than sheer endurance. During his Arctic years, he had learned from Inuit communities how to dress, travel, and conserve strength in freezing climates. He adopted their fur clothing, lightweight sleds, and reliance on dogs, choices some European explorers dismissed as primitive. Yet these decisions became the

foundation of his triumph. Dogs offered speed, endurance, and, if necessary, food for others, reflecting the harsh pragmatism essential for survival in Antarctica.

Scott's team, by contrast, embodied Edwardian ideals of moral heroism. They wore heavy wool clothing that absorbed moisture, rejected dogs in favor of ponies unsuited to the cold, and relied on human effort to haul supplies. This approach, guided by pride rather than practicality, ultimately doomed them. Where Amundsen valued efficiency, Scott trusted courage alone.

Amundsen's five-man team, Olav Bjaaland, Helmer Hanssen, Sverre Hassel, Oscar Wisting, and Amundsen, functioned with remarkable discipline. Every member had a specific role: navigation, dog-handling, carpentry, and record-keeping. Camps were organized identically each night, and observations on temperature, pressure, and altitude were logged with scientific precision. These records later helped map unknown regions of the Antarctic interior and remain valuable to researchers today.

Conditions were brutal. Temperatures plunged to -50°C , and blizzards could erase visibility in moments. The men endured frostbite and snow blindness but maintained morale through routine and leadership. Amundsen's journal rarely revealed emotion, each entry a brief note of progress and weather. Only at the Pole did he write, "We have achieved our goal. The journey has been successful, though not without suffering."

At 90° South, they planted the Norwegian flag and built a small tent, Polheim, "Home at the Pole." Inside, Amundsen placed letters for King Haakon VII and for Scott. After verifying their coordinates over several days, they began the return journey. Despite strong headwinds and exhaustion, all five men and eleven dogs returned safely to base camp after ninety-nine days, a logistical perfection unmatched in polar history.

When Scott's group arrived over a month later, they found the Norwegian flag already standing. In his diary, Scott wrote bitterly, "The worst has happened. All the daydreams must go." The British party's return was marked by starvation and extreme weather. Scott and his remaining companions perished on the Ross Ice Shelf, their bodies found months later with Amundsen's letter among their belongings.

Public reaction was divided. In Norway, Amundsen was celebrated as a national hero. In Britain, Scott's death was transformed into a symbol of noble failure and patriotic endurance. For years, British media favored Scott's moral courage over Amundsen's technical superiority. Only later did historians recognize Amundsen's expedition as not merely a race but a scientific achievement in logistics and meteorology.

Amundsen continued exploring for over a decade, applying the same disciplined methods in the Arctic and attempting the North Pole by air. His final flight in 1928, to rescue a stranded explorer, ended in disappearance, his body never recovered. In that sense, his life both began and ended in the frozen frontiers he had devoted himself to mastering.

Modern scientists still rely on the meteorological records his team collected in 1911–1912, which provide early climate data for the Antarctic plateau. His methods, careful planning, small teams, reliance on local knowledge, remain foundational principles of extreme-environment expeditions today.

Historians often interpret Amundsen's and Scott's journeys as reflections of national character. Amundsen embodied Norway's seafaring pragmatism and respect for nature's limits. Scott, by contrast, symbolized Britain's romantic ideal of courage through adversity. Both shared ambition and devotion, yet only Amundsen's realism aligned with the conditions of the Antarctic.

The conquest of the South Pole ultimately represented more than a national victory. It was a turning point in exploration itself, a shift from heroic adventure to calculated science. Amundsen's success demonstrated that survival in the planet's harshest regions depended not on strength of will alone but on humility, precision, and respect for the environment's unforgiving logic.

Questions 1 - 7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1? In boxes 1-7 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information*

FALSE *if the statement contradicts the information*

NOT GIVEN *if there is no information on this*

1. Amundsen's decision to delay his journey in September helped prevent possible deaths.
2. Scott's team used dogs for transportation just like Amundsen's did.
3. Amundsen's expedition benefited from techniques learned from the Inuit people.
4. Scott's team reached the South Pole before Amundsen's party.
5. All members of Amundsen's group were trained in skiing and dog-handling.
6. Amundsen's achievements were immediately recognized as scientifically significant.
7. Records from Amundsen's expedition continue to assist modern climate research.

Questions 8 - 13

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 8-13 on your answer sheet.

Roald Amundsen's Journey to the South Pole

Early motivation

- Initially planned an expedition to the **8**
- Changed plans after hearing about Robert Peary's disputed **9**

First attempt and retreat

- Started too early and suffered from **10** feet.
- Decided to return to base to protect his men's **11**

Final expedition and success

- Reached the South Pole on December 14, 1911.
- Left letters for King Haakon VII and for **12**
- Returned safely to base after **13** days.

READING PASSAGE 2

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14–26, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.

Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, A–F.

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

Write the correct number, i–ix, in boxes 14–19 on your answer sheet.

List of Headings

- i** Evidence that man's ancestors had a concept of the future
- ii** Research into the relation between brain size and memory
- iii** Animals that can remember place and time
- iv** Research into various animals' capacity for future planning
- v** A memory type described with reference to brain damage
- vi** Conflicting experimental results concerning animal memory
- vii** Research evidence of memory loss in various animals
- viii** Experimental evidence of a relation between past and future in human mental processes
- ix** Research into ways to improve episodic memory

14. Paragraph A

15. Paragraph B

16. Paragraph C

17. Paragraph D

18. Paragraph E

19. Paragraph F

Do animals really remember?

Research into different kinds of memory

A Humans are born time travellers: we can relive events that happened long ago or imagine ourselves in the future. Clues about different kinds of memory can be discovered from research conducted on people with certain brain injuries that cause them to forget autobiographical details without forgetting the information they picked up along the way. A man known as KC in the scientific literature, for instance, could play chess with no memory of having ever played it before. He could also remember sentences psychologists taught him without any memory of the lessons. KC had lost what psychologists now call 'episodic memory'. Dr Endel Tulving, a Canadian psychologist, defined episodic memory as the ability to recall the details of personal experiences: what happened, where it happened, when it happened and so on. Dr Tulving argued that episodic memory was distinct from other kinds of memory and that it was unique to our species.

B But are humans alone in this respect? Dr Nicola Clayton, of Cambridge University, has performed experiments which test American birds called western scrub jays to see if they met any of the criteria for episodic memory. The jays bury several thousand pieces of food a year and remember the location of each one. Dr Clayton wondered if scrub jays simply remembered the locations, or if they remembered details of the experience of hiding the food. She ran an experiment using two kinds of food: moth larvae and peanuts. Scrub jays prefer larvae to peanuts if the larvae are still fresh. However, if the larvae have been dead for even a few hours, the jays prefer peanuts. Dr Clayton gave the birds a chance to hide both kinds of food, in a sandy hiding area. Dr Clayton noted exactly what the birds had hidden and where, and then put the birds in a cage. She later returned the birds to the area where they had hidden the food, in some cases after four hours and in other cases after five days. The time the scrub jays had spent away from their hiding area affected the type of food they looked for. The birds that waited only four hours tended to dig up larvae, while the birds that had to wait for five days passed the larvae by and dug up peanuts instead. To make sure they were not just smelling the rotten larvae and avoiding those spots, Dr Clayton replaced the sand with fresh sand in the hiding area as soon as the birds had hidden the food.

C Research with other animals to determine if they are capable of episodic memory has had mixed results. When experimental rats are exploring a maze they seem to be able to recall which kinds of food they encounter along the way. Observation of hummingbirds as they feed appears to show that they remember where and when they visited individual flowers for nectar. Tests using Rhesus monkeys have found that they can remember where

they put food, but not how long ago they put it there.

D True episodic memory, argues Dr Thomas Suddendorf of Australia's Queensland University, involves more than just memory of information. It requires an awareness of the self and an ability to use the past to predict the future. He points to the discovery of stone tools which primitive humans used for killing animals 1.6 million years ago. Scientists assume that primitive humans had to find a way of adding much needed protein to their diet. Paleontologists have determined that some of these tools were moved many kilometres from where they were originally made. 'If you've just eaten, the only reason you're going to take a tool with you is if you anticipate using it in the future,' said Dr Suddendorf.

E Recent brain scanning studies provide physiological support for this link between past and future. Daniel Schacter, a psychologist at Harvard University, studied how brains function as people think about past experiences and imagine future ones. When Schacter's subjects constructed episodic memories, distinct networks of their brains became active, as recorded by brain scans. When they are asked to think about themselves in the future, many parts of the same episodic memory networks become active again, suggesting an inter-connection between the processing of the past and future.

F Dr Suddendorf's notions have spurred comparative psychologists to look for evidence that animals can also think ahead. Some studies suggest not. Cebus monkeys, for example, will eat until they are full and throw the rest of the food out of their cage, despite the fact that they will not have anything to eat the next morning. But in other studies, animals show more promise. 'We tested squirrel monkeys to see if they could anticipate the future, and to our surprise it looks like they could,' said Dr William Roberts, a comparative psychologist at the University of Western Ontario in Canada. He and his colleagues ran a test in which they gave squirrel monkeys a choice of between one or four dates to eat. Not surprisingly, the monkeys took four. But the scientists then began to take away water from the monkeys before they gave them the choice. If the monkeys took four, the scientists kept the water away for three hours. If the monkeys took one, the scientists returned it in half an hour. The monkeys learned to choose one. Though they were not thirsty at the time, they seemed to understand that they would become so in future.

Questions 20 and 21

Choose **TWO** letters, **A–E**.

Write the correct letters in boxes 20 and 21 on your answer sheet.

Which **TWO** of the following statements concerning episodic memory are found in the text?

- A.** Dr Tulving believes that most kinds of memory involve aspects of episodic memories.
- B.** The experimental subject KC was unable to recall the process by which he learned to play a particular board game.
- C.** In the case of KC, the subject's episodic memory was affected by his brain injuries.
- D.** Dr Tulving carried out extensive observations of the episodic memories of animals as well as humans.
- E.** To test his episodic memory, KC was given various mathematical problems to solve.

Questions 22 and 23

Choose **TWO** letters, **A–E**.

Write the correct letters in boxes 22 and 23 on your answer sheet.

Which **TWO** of the following statements are true concerning Dr Clayton's experiments with scrub jays?

- A.** The experiments indicated that the birds could remember how long their food had been buried.
- B.** In the experiments, the scrub jays preferred burying moth larvae to burying peanuts.
- C.** In the experiments, the birds were guided by the smell of the hidden food.
- D.** Scrub jays were taught by Dr Clayton to store food for future use.
- E.** Scrub jays would rather eat certain nuts than decaying moth larvae.

Questions 24–26

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes **24–26** on your answer sheet.*

What is ‘true’ episodic memory?

Dr Suddendorf believes that ‘true’ episodic memory requires the ability to use that memory for the future. He cites as evidence ancient **24** which early humans had taken some distance from where they had been originally fashioned. Dr Suddendorf’s theory is supported by scans showing the activation of certain networks in particular areas of the brain both by episodic memory and by consideration of the future.

Do non-human animals also exhibit ‘true’ episodic memory? Cebus monkeys appear to waste food once they are full, indicating that they do not plan for the future. However, in experiments, squirrel monkeys chose not to take the extra **25** they were offered as food, in anticipation of wanting **26** soon afterwards.



READING PASSAGE 3

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27 - 40, which are based on Reading Passage 3.

Lawrence Johnston and Hidcote Garden

Robin Lane Fox writes about the American genius behind a remarkable garden in the English Cotswolds

Today, the National Trust in the UK administers hundreds of public gardens, while sixty-odd years ago there was only one, Hidcote Manor near the English village of Chipping Campden. In 1949 Hidcote attracted a mere 600 visitors and took all of £30 during its first public season. Nowadays, Hidcote is famous worldwide as a masterpiece of design and planting, attracting 150,000 visitors and raising nearly £1 million from entrance tickets annually.

Hidcote Garden was the creation of an American in Britain, the shy Major Lawrence Johnston, who came to live on the site in 1907 with his widowed mother, Gertrude Winthrop. In some respects Winthrop feared her son's talents for expensive landscape gardening and never allowed him full access to the family's funds. Nonetheless, with her inspiration and guidance Johnston started his design in 1908 and brought it to a peak in the early 1930s when he was in his 60s. He may rightly be ranked at this time beside Harold Nicolson and Vita Sackville-West, creators of Sissinghurst, his garden's only surviving equal.

In the last years of his life, Johnston placed faith in his head gardener Nancy Lindsay. Lindsay was undoubtedly a skilled plantswoman but she had many other talents as well, including one for taking offence, and he was ill-suited to dealing with her impassioned views. When the National Trust subsequently acquired the garden from Johnston, none of his crucial garden diaries could be found, and some speculated that Lindsay had burned them to hurt her employer.

Whatever their actual fate, Trust gardener Graham Thomas was tasked with reviving Hidcote, and he had to manage without these crucial documents. Thomas knew that for the gardens to be a commercial success he needed to extend those areas that were of most interest to the general public, so he introduced new plants and a Mediterranean Bank where Johnston had had nothing of the sort, while retaining the existing superb structure of avenues and evergreen rooms. As a result, since 1949, the visiting public has innocently been admiring Thomas's flower plantings, not Johnston's own.

When the important designer Russell Page had visited Hidcote in 1934 he had hailed the half-hardy plants in the summer house as one of the highlights. But Thomas later got rid of them and pulled the house down, fearing such relatively colourless exhibits would not capture the public's imagination.

Then, in 2002, Johnston's old diaries and notebooks resurfaced. The present head gardener had started to give lectures about Hidcote's lost early designs, during which he appealed for memories from his audience. A few months later an envelope arrived. There was no letter inside, only Johnston's personal diaries from the 1920s and 30s. The sender may be unknown but the importance of these documents to Hidcote is certain, for they contain invaluable notes regarding the selection of plants and, even better still, detailed sketches by Johnston himself showing how the different parts of the garden are related and how those relationships evolve over the seasons.

These documents are a rarity in other ways too, for they never dwell on the issues so typically addressed in diaries—relationships, loves and longings. These are far more interesting, for they represent a classic social history of an English country house during the inter-war years. On page after page Johnston describes the layout of the plants and gardens, interspersed, for example, with that day's guests. The famous novelist Edith Wharton is recorded as coming for lunch, beside a recipe for poison to kill garden weeds. It is this mix of glamour and the everyday that makes the diaries of such peculiar fascination. At their heart, though, these are useful documents containing, for example, lengthy lists of those who might one day be of service around the estate, including local stone masons and glaziers, or repairers of broken china from as far away as France.

The discovery of the diaries has offered Hidcote a new direction for the years ahead. Inspired by them, an anonymous American has given the gardens £1.6 million. This is a remarkable chance, which the Trust has gladly seized upon to allow for crucial repair work on paths and the famous pool, together with the reconstruction of the old summer house. However, the real implications of the discoveries made from the diaries are more problematic, for now the Trust must take its collection of plants up one notch. We now possess information about the very plants that most appealed to Johnston in the garden's golden years. Today, these may not be easy to source, nor so appealing to contemporary tastes.

'But isn't it all so long ago?' a non-gardening academic recently asked me. On the contrary, Hidcote is still with us, a living legacy. It includes the greatest central vista in British gardening, the design I regard as the greatest in British art in the past century. It was the work of an American genius building an un-American garden of his own. I do not

believe the fashionable guess nowadays that Johnston was informed by books on contemporary design by Britain's Thomas Mawson, an altogether less innovative mind. This is not least because there is so much in the garden to remind us how Johnston had travelled widely in Europe, which Mawson had not. It is Johnston's own origins, the events of his life, and his individual design flair that contribute to making Hidcote so unique.



Questions 27 - 31

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

Write the correct letter in boxes 27 - 31 on your answer sheet

27. What does the writer say about Hidcote Garden in the first paragraph?

- A. It is the most popular with overseas visitors.
- B. Its popularity has increased over the years.
- C. It has increased in size since first opening.
- D. It is the largest garden administered by the National Trust.

28. The writer refers to the Sissinghurst garden in order to

- A. illustrate Hidcote's significance.
- B. highlight two of Johnston's critics.
- C. identify one of Johnston's inspirations.
- D. compare Hidcote to a garden that no longer exists.

29. What does the writer suggest about Nancy Lindsay?

- A. She was injured in an accident.
- B. She was head gardener after Johnston's death.
- C. She lacked the necessary gardening talent.
- D. She may have had a disagreement with Johnston.

30. According to the writer, which of the following is true about Graham Thomas?

- A. The public does not realise his contribution to the garden.
- B. He did not have a sufficiently commercial mind.
- C. He revived the garden based on the diaries.
- D. The public disliked his part of the garden.

31. The writer refers to Russell Page in order to

- A. evaluate Thomas's work.
- B. criticise one of Thomas's rivals.
- C. give an example of Thomas's approach.
- D. correct a common mistake about Thomas.

Questions 32 - 36

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–I**, below.

Write the correct letter, **A–I**, in boxes 32 - 36 on your answer sheet.

The Discovery of Johnston's Diaries

As a result of talks of the garden's **32**, Johnston's diaries were returned by an anonymous source. Most valuable of all for today's gardeners at Hidcote were **33**, revealing how the garden changed in the course of the year. From the diaries, we learn little of Johnston's **34**, Instead, they contain a fascinating combination of the exotic, such as stories of well known **35**, and the more practical, like how to contact **36** in a foreign country. Overall, the diaries present challenges, because we now know exactly what plants Johnston favoured.

A drawings

B plantings

C private life

D original plans

E opportunities

F craftsmen

G visitors

H future

I poems

Questions 37 - 40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3? In boxes 37-40 on your answer sheet, write:

YES if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

37. Gardening may be considered a form of art.

38. The original design of Hidcote should be retained as closely as possible.

39. Mawson was the most significant influence on Johnston's work.

40. Hidcote reflects aspects of Johnston's life experience.